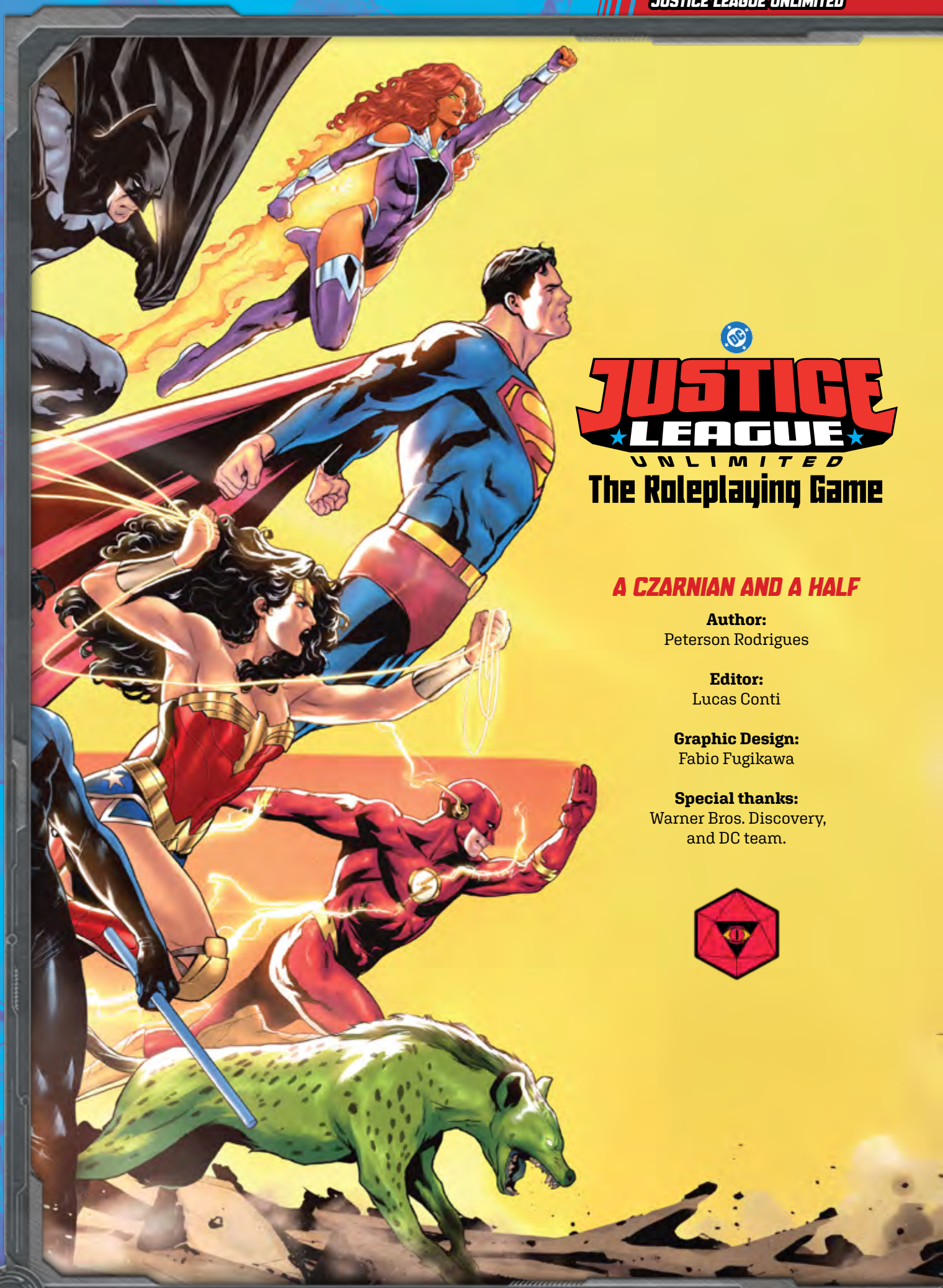
A CZARNIAN AND A HALF

JUSTICE LEAGUE UNLIMITED
The Roleplaying Game



QUICKPLAY EXPANSION

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A CZARNIAN AND A HALF

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A CZARNIAN AND A HALF

This adventure is part of the pre-campaign of Justice League Unlimited: The Roleplaying Game and to be better understood, you'll need the Quickstart available for free on Drivethru RPG.

INTRODUCTION

This is an adventure made to be used with the Justice League Unlimited RPG Quickstart, and will take a group of **Tier C** Heroes on a mission that involves Project CADMUS and Lobo, the intergalactic bounty Hunter. They will fight their way through a secret underground facility to uncover the truth and complete the mission.

Divided into two parts, *A Czarnian and a Half* is intended to be played as a single fast-paced issue, focused on relentless action and the pressure of time as the Heroes face threats far beyond their weight class.

THE EDITORIAL BRIEFING

This issue delivers an action–packed fast paced adventure where the Heroes must run against time to unveil the hidden truth behind CADMUS secret lab, and deal with a very angry Czarnian bounty hunter. The premise is as simple as it gets: A black-budget biogenetics facility hidden beneath the shipping docks of Metropolis has experienced a catastrophic security breach.

Forget about a street gang using explosives and whatnot–The point of entry was physically unpeeled by an extraordinary amount of force. Three inches of reinforced titanium plating were folded like paper.

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The entity responsible is **Lobo**, the Main Man (c'mon, he needs no introduction) who tracked an illegal genetic transaction right to the facility's front door, and broke in with the subtlety of a dinosaur-extinguishing meteor. Unfortunately, the facility directors are many things, but helpless academics they are not, and in response they have deployed their primary corporate defenses: a network of heavy-duty automated robot sentinels designed to leave no stone unturned.

Their directives couldn't be more clear– protect the corporation, preserve the hierarchy of command , leave no evidence nor witnesses. And these automatons are deadly effective at their job. Now the docks became a war zone, with civilians trapped on the damaged infrastructure, automated kill-squads and **f#%$** Lobo.

Amidst the chaos, the Heroes come into play. Sent there by direct command of a senior League member,they must contain the crisis as effectively as possible,prioritizing civilian lives, manage a fracturing municipal infrastructure and decide whether to neutralize the bounty hunter or align with him against a corrupt corporate syndicate.

CADMUS: Metropolis is no stranger to Project CADMUS. Officially operating as a state-of-the-art bio-genetics company, focusing on advanced security and bioengineering, behind the curtains it is a morally ambiguous organization. From projects involving cloning, the manufacturing of super-soldiers, and controlled evolution, CADMUS stands at the center of this adventure.



Fighting Lobo: The Heroes are probably no match for the Main Man. At least in the traditional mano a mano sense. Should the Heroes choose to engage in direct confrontation with the bounty hunter, they quickly realize that taking Lobo head-on is biting off more that they to chew–wich does not mean that he is unbeatable. As the Editor, you must encourage the group to find innovative ways to contain the thread, such as..well...good luck with it.

THE THREE PATHS OF TRUTH

This adventure gives different options to what is really going on. Before running the issue, the Editor must select one of the following hidden truths to govern the investigation tracks. Each one will provide different terminal data logs, matching narrative parley triggers and an overall definition of the adventure.

Finding the Evidence: Each truth provides e Evidence of what is really happening behind the curtains, giving the Heroes a panoramic view of the situation. This will dictate how they deal with the corporation and the Main Man, leading to one of the possible endings. Truth be told, nothing is more disappointing than not finding the clues to move the story forward. That should not be the case here: The real question is how the evidence will be found, and not if it will be found. Let the Heroes describe their actions, and how it leads them to founding it.

Truth 1: The Space-Dolphin Extortion

The rogue scientists illegally intercepted and poached a pod of deep-space-Dolphins. These animals (or, well, aliens) are sacred cosmic fauna , and Lobo treats them as his personal companions, holding the creatures in his highest regards. Cadmus is actively distilling the dolphins' psychic neural fluid to synthesize a concentrated metagene-suppressor serum for corporate buyers. Lobo is in a blood-rage because they touched his pod.

The Evidence: Mainframe logs tracking an off-world transit manifest labeled Project Cetacean-Fluid.

If a Hero uses Mind (Tech) to download the coordinates of the off-world transport ship holding the dolphins and hands it to Lobo, he instantly ceases hostilities against the League, grins, and offers to let them join him in dismantling the remaining corporate architecture.

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Truth 2: The Sovereign Ledger Fraud

The laboratory directors were hired by an interstellar extremist cell to harvest Czarnian stem cells and engineer a localized bio-weapon capable of neutralizing the metagene of Earth's heroes. To acquire the genetic material, they tricked Lobo into signing a fraudulent bounty contract, using an encrypted sub-routine to lock him out of his offshore bank accounts on Oa.

The Evidence: A secure datapad containing the forged contract and the digital financial signatures of the directors.

Showing Lobo the ledger proving he was the mark of a white-collar scam activates his personal code. He will immediately pivot his aggression away from the heroes, rev his space-chopper, and ask the team's strategist for the fastest vector to execute a total demolition of the directors' offices.

Truth 3: The Infant Paradox

The laboratory successfully utilized a stolen genetic strand to grow "Lobo-Two"—an infant clone engineered with accelerated maturation protocols to serve as a mindless super-soldier asset. Lobo is furious that someone copied his visage without paying him royalties. However, the baby isn't mindless, and already possesses the baseline Czarnian temper.

The Evidence: The central incubation cylinder containing the infant clone aggressively chewing through a titanium pacifier.

If the hero holding the baby during the clash allows the infant to violently bite Lobo's finger or flip him off, Lobo enters a state of proud, psychotic paternal joy. He declares the kid a true little bastich and aligns with the heroes to execute a total demolition of the facility as a family bonding exercise.

PROBING INVOLVEMENT QUESTIONS

Ask your players these questions before the deployment sequence to establish their tactical approach and personal stakes:

The Underworld Legend: To the hero with a street or criminal background: You've heard whispers about the Broken Tusk dive bar in Hob's Bay. Which intergalactic bounty hunter on your sheet owes you a favor from your early days, and what rule of bar etiquette do you know must never be broken inside that room?

The Robotic Analysis: To the genius or tech-expert: Cadmus utilizes reverse-engineered automated defense units. Looking at the satellite telemetry of the breach, what specific flaw in their targeting processors do you know can be exploited to force them into a systemic logic loop?

The Non-Lethal Boundary: To the most idealistic or compassionate hero: You are tracking a target who famously wiped out his entire species for a high school science project. If the rogue scientists inside this bunker are exposed as white-collar monsters, how will you ensure your team maintains the League's moral code when Lobo offers to solve the problem permanently?

THE DOOMSDAY CLOCK

The Editor manages this 6-Segment Doomsday Clock openly to simulate the destruction of the municipal infrastructure. Mark one segment at the end of every major confrontation where the

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heroes fail a high-stakes heroic action, engage in prolonged tactical debates, or choose to pause for an Interlude Moment to recover.

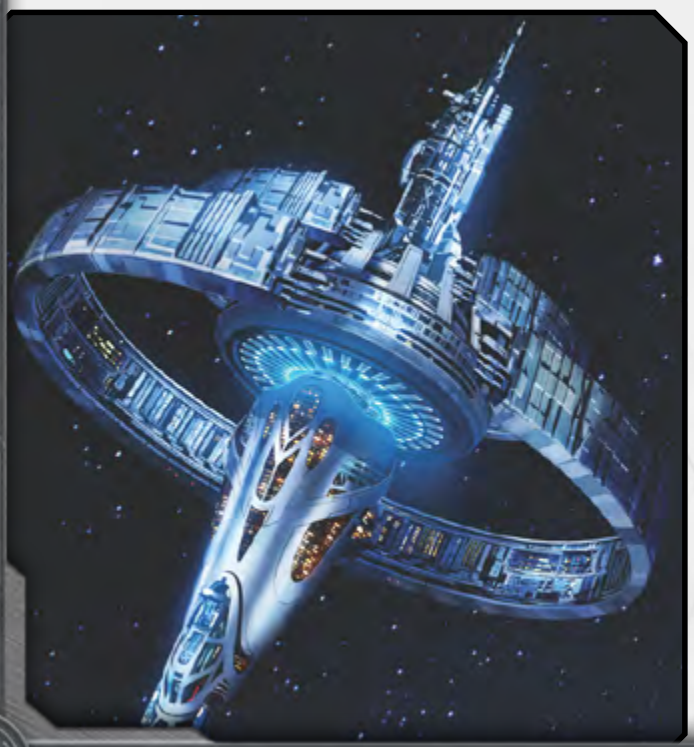
Segments 1-2: Structural Fracture. Lobo's chain-hook strikes shatter the foundational pillars. Overloaded power lines feed high-voltage current back into the structural metal. All physical Agility and Potency checks across all zones suffer a permanent +2 Tension modifier due to falling debris and smoke.

Segment 3: Circuit Overload. The automated defenses fry the bunker's secondary backup batteries. Emergency chemical gas lines begin to crack and warp. Erratic electrical arcs begin targeting randomly across the immediate area.

Segment 4: Sensation Flare. The structural disorientation expands to the Far range. The TENSION level for all Mind and Spirit Tests increases by +3 across the entire sandbox due to toxic gas leaks and psychic feedback.

Segment 5: Total Instability. The severe thermal contrast causes the concrete support pillars of the street level to structurally crack. A total civilian evacuation of the lower streets becomes mandatory.

Segment 6: Absolute Demolition (Mission Failure). The containment cells shatter completely. Lobo overrides the municipal grid, causing a localized explosion that levels the entire city block. Lobo escapes into the coastal fog with the genetic asset, leaving the League's reputation ruined.



PART 1: THE UNDERGROUND FACILITY

The Directives

The Watchtower is the physical manifestation of the JLU: thousands of heroes, from street vigilantes to gods among men can be found throughout its myriad of halls and chambers. In the cafeteria, Plastic Man is testing a fresh batch of new jokes on a specially tough crowd while Animal Man studies a newly discovered interstellar species in the Menagerie.

The issue begins in the briefing room of the Watchtower. The heroes are gathered before the main holographic display array. A holographic display of Red Tornado speak directly with the Heroes, his expression serious as he filters through satellite feeds of Metropolis.

> *"League strike team, look at the telemetry for Sector 4, Hob's Bay. Five minutes ago, an off-the-books biogenetics facility hidden beneath the docks went completely dark. This wasn't a standard industrial accident. Long-range sensors detected a localized kinetic spike equivalent to a Class-A metahuman strike, but our facial recognition arrays caught a glimpse of the perpetrator before the grid failed: Lobo is on the ground.*
>
> *We are dealing with a highly volatile corporate asset containment. Government cleanup crews are already deploying to scrub the site and bury the evidence, meaning you are operating in a strict temporal bottleneck. Your orders are absolute: Descend into the facility, stabilize the automated security units, secure any surviving civilian personnel, and extract the Cadmus data cores. Do not engage Lobo in a war of attrition; your priority is salvage and reconnaissance. Go."*

The Subterranean Breach

Dropping through the upper ventilation access, the heroes infiltrate the subterranean facility beneath them. The environment is an immediate assault on the senses. The thunderous sound of heavy machinery blends with the acrid scent of oil and ozone. In this area, the Heroes must gather clues and protect the scientists that are under attack by the very corporation they work for.

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The Incinerated Hangar

"The deep staging bay of the Cadmus bunker is a wreck of twisted alloy and shattered concrete. The concrete ceiling is spider-webbed, leaking water and grease from the docks above. Inside, the lab is a smoking war zone. Shattered server racks spark violently, throwing harsh ultraviolet reflections against the damp walls.

The floor is flooded with glowing green amniotic fluid from destroyed incubation tanks, creating a highly conductive, chemical mire. A toxic fire is rapidly spreading toward a cluster of pressurized gas lines. Through the smoke, the facility's automated defenses are malfunctioning.

Three towering Autonomous Constructs—heavy steel security droids with gatling-laser arms—have their targeting matrices corrupted. Their lenses flare a blind crimson light as they lock their lasers directly onto a group of scientists pinned beneath a collapsed steel girder."

Malfunctioning Constructs

The facility is guarded by Autonomous Constructs operating as a Group threat. On their turn, they use their gatling-lasers to systematically execute the pinned scientists to wipe out the facility's witnesses, completely ignoring the Heroes if not attacked.The heroes must spend their actions or deployment turns to destroy the droids or project active shields to intercept the shots before the civilians are vaporized.

The Amniotic Mire

The floor of the hangar is covered in a slick layer of green amniotic fluid mixed with industrial oil. Any character attempting a movement action on foot across this zone must pass an Agility Test against Tension 17. If they fail, they slide out of control, fall Prone, and immediately lose any remaining actions for that turn. Characters with flight capabilities completely bypass this hazard.

Heroic Actions and the Collapsing Infrastructure

The Heroes must accumulate 2 Successes before 3 Failures across these specific operational tracks to stabilize the area and discover the truth before the facility structures collapse.

Failing: If they fail, the underground facility collapses. The Heroes must use their powers and abilities to work as a team and avoid the worst case scenario. Each member must make a Test against Tension 20, describing how they will try to survive. On a failure, that Hero must Mark 2 Conditions. See "Catapulted to the Main Stage"

Heave the Steel Girder (Tension 21): A powerhouse must brace their shoulders beneath the shifting steel beam to let the injured technicians drag themselves out of the debris. Failure Consequence: The beam slips on the chemical gel, dropping an inch further and pinning the target harder, forcing the scientists to mark a condition.

Suppress the Chemical Flash (Tension 18): Reprogramming the automated Halon gas arrays or using a localized energy shield to starve the chemical fire of oxygen. Success chokes out the flames with a sharp hiss; failure advances the Doomsday Clock by 1 segment.

Mainframe Interrogation (Tension 22): Slicing into the smoking server racks before they melt. Success pulls up the attacker's final search query: coordinates for a secondary holding facility located directly beneath the Broken Tusk bar. If the player explicitly states they are downloading the core encryption codes, they secure the data necessary to trigger Ending B or Ending D later.

The Scientists: A group of 1d6+1 scientists is led by Ocatavia Singer, a middle-aged woman who, although proud of the work they did, is furious with how CADMUS betrayed her and her team, and if the Heroes successfully rescue them, she is ready to collaborate with the Heroes, providing a way to the Evidence.

Catapulted to the Main Stage

Once the second success is secured or the scientists are freed, the heroes extract the central data files. They realize the truth chosen by the Editor: Cadmus has crossed a line, and Lobo isn't here for a random rampage—he is hunting down a specific corporate asset.

The second the data is verified, a deafening roar shakes the bedrock. Lobo, operating in the deeper vault chambers, swings his heavy chain-hook into the main fuel-scrubbing line. The spark hits the pressurized reserve.

A massive, concussive explosion rips through the foundation of the underground bunker. The floor completely gives way, and the sheer

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force of the structural blast launches the heroes, the debris, the automated server frames, and the central containment unit upward through ten feet of reinforced concrete. They are physically catapulted through the floorboards of the Broken Tusk bar above, shattering the street level and spilling out into the open air of Hob's Bay.

PART 2: THE STREET SHOWDOWN

The Main Stage

"The shockwave blasts you through the asphalt, slamming you onto the neon-lit docks of Hob's Bay. Water from shattered fire hydrants sprays forty feet into the night air, mixing with the harbor rain. Smashed hover-cars alarm, and terrified civilian crowds scatter across the shipping lanes.

Through the settling dust cloud of the crater, a glowing red cigar ember pierces the darkness. Lobo steps out, brushing pulverized concrete off his leather vest without a single scratch on his pale skin. He spins his heavy bladed chain-hook, tearing chunks out of the street.

Behind him, the central Cadmus incubation cylinder sits exposed on the broken pavement, its biometric cables sparking violently. Lobo levels his gaze at your positions, heavy metal music still blaring from his bike's intact speakers. 'Nice ride, bastiches,' he growls. 'But the Main Man always collects his property. Step aside.'"

Cadmus Shock Troopers: 1d6+2 of these threats arrive at the start of the Scene. They are ready to protect Cadmus property, attacking Lobo at full force. The Heroes can act as a third neutral party, or take sides with one of the fronts.

The Fluid Slick

The street surrounding the crater is coated in the remaining amniotic gel and engine oil blasted from the bunker. Moving across this zone on foot requires strict coordination. Any character making a movement action must pass an Agility Test against Tension 17 or slide out of control and fall Prone.

Collateral Effects

Lobo does not care about infrastructure or civilian casualties. He will actively use the urban environment to flush out the Heroes.

The Cargo Crane Projectile (Round 2): Lobo digs his hands under a massive dockside shipping crane and hurls it like a spear directly into an evacuation bus. A hero must sacrifice their Main Action to perform a Heroic Action against Tension 25 to catch or deflect the machinery mid-air. Failure results in the crane impacting the vehicle, advancing the Doomsday Clock by 1 segment.

The Fuel Tanker Bomb (Round 4): Lobo rips a glowing plasma fuel cell from an overturned transport and hurls it at the foundation of a dockside warehouse where civilians are sheltering. A hero must use a Heroic Action against Tension 29 to intercept the bomb or project an energy barrier. Failure causes the structure to collapse, imposing the Shaken status condition on all heroes due to the psychological blow.

Resolutions and Endings

The Editor should openly inform the players after Lobo's first regeneration cycle: *"Physical force will not end this fight. You must find a creative narrative solution to deal with him."* The players can trigger one of four definitive endings based on their tactical choices:

Ending A: The Orbital Banishment

The heroes focus entirely on spatial removal. A tech-expert or magic-user utilizes their Main Action to initialize a high-intensity Boom Tube or dimensional portal directly behind the villain (Mind/Technology or Spirit/Magic vs Tension 29). The remaining heroes must use their actions to execute a coordinated knockback maneuver to force Lobo's frame across the threshold. Lobo flies backward into the rift, flashing a middle finger as the portal snaps shut safely. The asset is secured in League custody, and the city block is saved.

Ending B: The Sovereign Ledger Bribe

This ending is only accessible if the heroes successfully downloaded the data from the Cadmus mainframe before the explosion. A hero yells out that they possess the secure digital ledger keys to the Cadmus directors' offshore bank accounts or the exact transport data of his

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stolen pod. Passing a Spirit (Persuasion or World of Crime) test against Tension 25 causes Lobo to freeze mid-swing. He catches the data drive, reves his space-chopper, and rockets into the upper atmosphere to hunt down the corporate executives, leaving the genetic asset behind as a freebie.

Ending C: The Paternal Accord

Unlocked only if Truth 3 was selected. A hero drops their defensive posture and allows Lobo to lift the infant clone out of the incubation fluid by the back of its shirt. The baby clone doesn't cry; it stares Lobo dead in the eyes and violently bites his thumb down to the bone, letting out a raspy, psychotic giggle. Lobo enters a state of proud, paternal joy, strappes the baby into his space-chopper's sidecar, and declares him a true little bastich. He leaves the heroes in peace, giving the kid a fifty-year head start before he comes back to hunt him down.

Ending D: The Vanguard Alliance

This ending is accessible if the heroes analyze the data cores, realize the horrific extent of Cadmus's illegal bio-warfare experiments, and decide Lobo has the moral right to reclaim his property or avenge his companions.

The Execution: A hero openly yields the genetic asset or delivers the decrypted tracking files to Lobo, declaring an alliance against the rogue syndicate. This requires a Spirit (Leadership or Persuasion) test against Tension 22 to match Lobo's mercenary respect.

The Alliance Turn: Lobo grins, chomps his cigar, and stands side-by-side with the League. When the CADMUS. cleanup kill-squads and automated tactical drones arrive to sterilize the block, Lobo fights as an allied Tier A combatant under the heroes' strategic direction.

The Outcome: Together, the heroes and Lobo completely dismantle the government clean-up forces, secure the data proving corporate corruption, and extract the civilian scientists safely. Lobo departs into the stars with his property intact, flashing a rare grunt of respect to the League, leaving the team with a permanent, high-tier wildcard contact in the interstellar underworld.



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THREAT SHEETS

LOBO

Immortal Monster
Villain

Protocol: Lobo is a dangerous bounty hunter who only cares about fulfilling his contracts and the large amounts of money involved. An extremely capable combatant, his regeneration is one of the most powerful in the universe, making him virtually immortal. The Main Man is more of a force of nature than a villain himself, and his code of conduct makes him treat every contract as a job that must be completed, nothing more.

Resolve: 100 **Defense:** 28 **DR:** 3

Condition Boxes: ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

Attributes

Potency: +18, **Accuracy:** +9, **Agility:** +9, **Resistance:** +12, **Spirit:** +6, **Mind:** +3

Attacks

Chain-Hook: +15 to hit. **Damage:** 1d8 + 18 (Physical) [Near Range]

Smash: +20 to hit. **Damage:** 1d8 + 18 (Physical) [Adjacent Range]

Powers

Extreme Regeneration Grade 5, Super Strength Grade 4, , Enhanced Senses (Tracking Smell) Grade 5, Enhanced Resistance G3

Knowledge: World of Crime, Survival, Piloting

Traits: Tough as Nails, Immortal, Special Vehicle (Space motorcycle)



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Limitations

Code of Conduct: The Written Word: Lobo will never violate the explicit, signed terms of a mercenary contract once his credits have cleared on Oa.

Special Abilities

Acyclic Action: Lobo gains 1 extra independent Action executed immediately at the conclusion of any individual hero's turn. He uses this action solely to pursue or strike the character currently holding the asset.

Extreme Regeneration: Lobo regains 5 Resolve points at the beginning of every Round.

Enhanced Senses (Passive): Lobo gains a +6 bonus to any tracking test made using his sense of smell.

He Does Not Stay Down!: If (by some miracle) the Main Man is Defeated, he returns to Wounded with half his Resolve points.

It tickles! (Reaction): Whenever Lobo is targeted and hit by a critical hit or high-intensity superpower energy blast, his biology absorbs the impact. He expends 3 points of Resolve to instantly snap his framework back into alignment, completely ignoring any Stunned or Slowed status conditions the attack would impose.

The Chain-Drag (Activation / 1 Action): Lobo launches his hook at a target within Near range (+15 to hit). On a hit, instead of dealing damage, the target must pass an Opposed Potency Test against Lobo's Potency (+12). Failure means they are pulled into Adjacent range, landing them Prone.

It's Only Business: At the start of an Issue, one of the Heroes in the group (or all of them!) becomes the target of one of Lobo's bounty hunter contracts. The Villain gains Advantage on Attack rolls and deals +1 damage die against that target. The Contract lasts until the target is defeated.

Frag 'Em All: Once per round, Lobo can make a free attack against anyone who enters his "Close" distance.

The Main Man Rule: Lobo cannot be permanently defeated by reducing his Resolve to 0. Every time he marks Defeated, Lobo stands up in the subsequent round with 50 Resolve and all conditions cleared. The heroes must deploy narrative solutions to resolve the clash.

Autonomous Construct

Tier: D
Minion

Resolve: 10 **Defense:** 12

Attributes

Potency: +6, **Accuracy:** +3, **Agility:** +3, **Resistance:** +3, **Spirit:** 0, **Mind:** -3
Gatling-Laser Arm: +6 to hit. **Dano:** 1d6+3 (Energy) [Near Range]

Special Skills:

Civilian Protocol (Passive): Unless actively blocked by a hero's physical frame, cover, or a force field construct, the Sentinel prioritizes firing on the pinned scientists rather than attacking the heroes.

Minion Life: The Autonomous Construct is Defeated Upon receiving any Damage.

Cadmus Shock Troopers

Tier: C
Group (Near)

Origin: Human **Resolve:** 45 **Defense:** 18 **DR:** 3

Condition Boxes: ☐ ☐ ☐

Attributes

Potency: +9, **Accuracy:** +6, **Agility:** +3, **Resistance:** +6, **Spirit:** 0, **Mind:** 0

Attacks

Strike: +12 to hit. **Damage:** 2d8+9 (Physical)

Energy Gun: +9 to hit. **Damage:** 1d8+6 (Energy) [Near Range]

Special Skills

Barrage of Attacks: A Group hits every target within the area it occupies with its Attacks.

Group Damage: While the Group has more than half of its total Resolve remaining, its Damage Die is increased by one step (1d6 to 1d8) above the normal value for its Tier.

Frontline Casualties: Whenever a Group loses half of its current Resolve (22), reduce the area it occupies by one category. Every time it loses half of its remaining Resolve again, apply Frontline Casualties once more.

Relentless Strength (Passive): In accordance with standard brute parameters, the trooper's first successful close-range Pneumatic Strike each turn is automatically executed with Advantage.

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